

the business never took a dime of outside capital. Cash flows provided all the growth capital and then some. Cash was always very tight as we were growing very rapidly and reinvesting all available capital to scale. In late 1991, I found a terrific banker, Tom Harazim, who liked our story. He paid off all my credit cards, got us off the very expensive factoring of receivables I was doing to bring in cash as quickly as possible, and got TransTech set up with a hugely cheaper line of credit based on our pristine receivables.

We did a sale of some assets for about \$2 million in 1994—which made me feel rich for the first time. And then the entire business was sold in 2000 for several million dollars. A \$30,000 investment got me more than 150-times return over 10 years—an annualized return of well over 65 percent. I went from a salary of \$45,000 a year (when I quit my job) to consistently having a salary of over \$300,000 a year in a few years. The magic word is Dhandho, baby—huge upside with virtually no downside. It was a classic “Heads, I win; tails I don’t lose much” kind of bet!